MADT 7202 · Mid-Term Applied Case

Which Rival Weakness Should Our New Cozy Game Turn Into Its Strength?

Rebuilt, reproducible analysis · Steam negative-review snapshot · 15 rival cozy games

DECISION

Make STORY & CHARACTERS our differentiating strength.

It is a qualified complaint in 4/15 rivals; Progression & Pacing is louder, but appears in only 3/15.

1. The decision and why this is a network

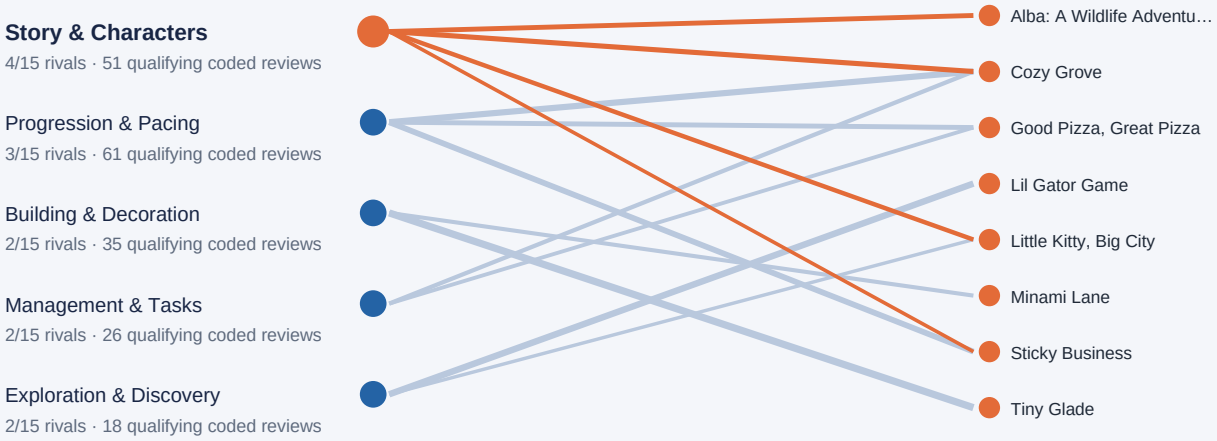
Before pre-production, the studio must choose one experience to do noticeably better. A table would choose the most frequent complaint, which can be driven by a few games. The bipartite network ranks market breadth: how many distinct rivals connect to each complaint.

2. Data and scope

Frozen run: 2,270 recent negative Steam reviews from 15 fixed rivals; English 2,266, Thai 4; 2019-09-14–2026-10-15. Max 200 reviews/game/language.

3. Network result — one line = a qualifying game × complaint relationship

Edge rule: ≥5 coded reviews AND ≥5% of that game's sampled negative reviews. Orange = game; blue = complaint.



4. Construction and robustness checks

Each whole review belongs to one game. A line does NOT mean games are directly related: it means players in that one game raised the coded complaint often enough to pass the rule. A topic is coded only when a topic phrase or a topic word within about ten words of a negative cue appears in the same sentence—never from a bare feature word. Weight is conditional share, count(game, topic)/count(game), following Chapter 6 Scheme 4. The ranking excludes generic technical, price/value and short-content complaints. Unit tests verify that bare feature mentions are not coded as complaints.

5. Action, comparison and limits

Action: budget a character-writing and dialogue loop: distinct character arcs, choices that affect relationships, and playtest narrative clarity before content scale. Comparison: Progression & Pacing has 80 coded matches versus Story's 82, but reaches 3 rather than 4 rivals—why the network changes the decision. Robustness: Story wins 6 of 9 predeclared cutoff settings; at the strict 8% cutoff, Progression wins. Limit: recent, self-selected English-heavy negative reviews are not all players or causal proof.

Reproducibility: rebuild_analysis.py → outputs/ → build_report.py · raw text not published; de-identified snapshot SHA-256: de2434556218bd7fd2777012d2dc7c8a039828c584095753c08720625d39dd69 Branch: codex/rebuild-validated-analysis